

Sample Question
Subject: English 1st Paper
Grade: Eight

Time: 3 hours

Marks: 100

[Marks for individual items are mentioned next to the test items]

Part A - Reading (Marks: 70)

Read the text and answer the questions 1 & 2

People's music, also known as folk music, consists of tunes, lyrics, and knowledge passed down orally for generations. Over time, this music has evolved, closely tied to the way people live. Our agriculture, food, ecology, seasons, and rituals are all reflected in these songs. Palligiti, Bhatiyali, Jari, Sari, Gambhira, Lalon Giti, Paalagan, and the songs of Hason Raja all embody the self-expression of the people.

As the landscape changes, the music shifts too. In the hill tracts, you encounter music with the same role but expressed in the diverse languages of the ethnic communities. The instruments used for folk music are crafted from materials found in the surroundings—animal skin, bamboo, and calabash are common examples. The sounds they produce are deeply connected to the land they come from.

As people migrate to cities and villages transform, these traditional tunes are slowly fading. However, folk music still finds its place in mainstream films and music albums.

1. Choose the best answer from the alternatives:

1x7=7

- a) The title “people’s music” stands for-**
- i. classical music
 - ii. popular music
 - iii. folk music
 - iv. jazz music
- b) What is a defining characteristic of folk music?**
- i. It is composed by famous musicians
 - ii. It only exists in urban areas
 - iii. It is passed down through generations orally
 - iv. It is always played using electronic instruments
- c) Which folk music form is associated with philosophical and spiritual themes?**
- | | |
|----------|----------------|
| i. Jari | iii. Bhatiyali |
| ii. Sari | iv. Lalon Giti |

- d) **How has folk music traditionally been passed down through generations?**
- i. through written manuscripts
 - ii. through printed songbooks
 - iii. through oral tradition
 - iv. through digital recordings
- e) **Which of the following folk music genres is known for being sung by boatmen?**
- i. Sari
 - ii. Jari
 - iii. Bhatiyali
 - iv. Gambhira
- f) **How does folk music help preserve cultural heritage?**
- i. by keeping traditional stories, values, and customs alive
 - ii. by replacing modern music trends
 - iii. by only allowing older people to perform it
 - iv. by being played only in historical museums
- g) **How is folk music still relevant in modern times?**
- i. It is integrated into films and music albums.
 - ii. It is only played in remote villages.
 - iii. It has completely disappeared.
 - iv. It is replaced by pop and rock music.

2. Write short answers to the following questions:

5x2=10

- a) How is folk music connected to people's daily lives?
- b) What materials are used to create folk music instruments, and why?
- c) Why is folk music slowly fading away?
- d) How is folk music in the hill tracts different from other regions?
- e) How does folk music help preserve cultural identity?

Read the text and answer the questions 3 & 4:

From that day onward, the children held that farmer in high esteem, and whenever they saw him, even as a distance, they would cry, "There's our farming teacher!" Whenever he had any fertilizer left, he would bring it over and

spread it on the children's field, and their crops grew well. Everyday, someone would visit the field and report to the head-master and the other children on how it was doing. The children learned to know the wonder and the joy of seeing the seeds they had planted themselves sprout. And whenever two or three of them were gathered together, talk would turn to the progress of their field.

3. Complete the passage with suitable words:

1x5=5

The children deeply (a) _____ the farmer and affectionately called him their "farming teacher" whenever they saw him. He supported their efforts by (b) _____ surplus fertilizer, which helped their crops thrive. Each day, a student would check on the field and report its (c) _____ to the headmaster and classmates. Through this experience, the children discovered the joy and wonder of seeing their own planted seeds grow. Their (d) _____ was so great that whenever they gathered in small groups, their (e) _____ naturally turned to the development of their field.

4. Read the passage carefully and replace the following words with their suitable synonyms or antonyms:

1x5=5

- | | |
|----------------------|------------------------|
| a) Esteem (Antonyms) | b) Distance (Synonyms) |
| c) Report (Synonyms) | d) Wonder (Antonyms) |
| e) Sprout (Synonyms) | |

Read the text and answer the questions 5, 6 & 7:

Lev Nikolayevich Tolstoy who is famously known as Leo Tolstoy was a Russian novelist, philosopher and moral critic. The writer was born on 9th September 1828 in Yasnaya Polyana, in Tula province of the Russian Empire at his family's estate. He had a traumatic childhood as he lost his mother, father and his aunt who were their local guardian and took care of him and his siblings after the demise of his biological parents.

He never completed his studies but managed to concentrate all his energy on his first journal. Later, while serving the army, he wrote his first novel “Childhood” which captured all his fondest memories of his childhood followed by many other books. His most critically acclaimed work that is still read all over the world is “War and Peace” followed by “Anna Karenina” and “The Death of Ivan Ilyich” which made him one of the most renowned novelists in the fiction genre.

He finally gave up all his wealth and acknowledged his wife all his copyrights of his work pre-1881 and headed to pilgrimage incognito. He died on 20th November 1910 in the same house. Later he was buried in his own family estate in Tula province in Yasnaya Polyana where the writer lost most of his beloved ones.

5. Complete the table with information from the passage:

1x5=5

Who/what?	Event	When/where?
Leo Tolstoy	(i)	In Russia
He had	a traumatic childhood	(ii).....
(iii)	his first novel	while serving the Army.
(iv).....	are the trilogy	made him world famous
He	was buried	(v).....

6. Read the statements below. Write ‘True’ if the statement is correct and ‘False’ if it is incorrect. If False, write the correct answer:

1x5=5

- Leo Tolstoy was born in Moscow, Russia.
- Tolstoy lost both of his parents and his aunt during his child hood.
- Tolstoy completed his studies before starting his writing career
- ‘War and Peace’ is one of Tolstoy’s most critically acclaimed hood.
- Tolstoy transferred the copyrights of all his works to his wife.

7. Write a summary of the passage in your own words: 10

8. Match the parts of sentences from the Columns A and B to make five complete sentences: 1x5=5

Column A	Column B
a) Garment workers generally work	i) are some of the major challenges that they face usually
b) Typically, he or she works	ii) they demand job security and better pay.
c) Low wages and long shifts	iii) for 12 to 14 hours a day.
d) Due to lack of skills,	iv) in factories and textile mills.
e) But, for their livelihood and future,	v) they don't have any alternative job opportunities.

9. Put the following parts of the story in correct order to make the whole story.

Only the corresponding numbers of the sentences need to be written: 1x8=8

- a) The traveler, astonished, asked why he was treated so well by a stranger.
- b) His home was always open, and his hands never empty of love for others.
- c) Without hesitation, Hatem invited him in, offering a feast of food and water.
- d) Word spread quickly of his hospitality, and people from all over came to witness his heart.
- e) Hatem Tai was known far and wide for his generosity and kindness.
- f) Hatem Tai's legacy of kindness lives on, reminding all to give without expecting in return.
- g) One day, a poor traveler came to his door, starving and thirsty.
- h) Hatem smiled and said, "Kindness costs nothing, but it enriches the soul

10. Answer any five of the following questions from the poems in your textbook:

2x5=10

- a) What does the embroidered quilt symbolize in the poem of The field of the embroidered quilt by Jasimuddin?
- b) What is the central theme of "Ode on Solitude" by Alexander Pope?
- c) What does the speaker pledge to the "Land of our Birth" in the opening lines of the poem "The Children's Songs" by Rudyard Kipling?
- d) How does the poem connect the themes of growth and emotional expression in the poem "A Little Plant"?
- e) Why do the wild geese begin their journey in the poem "Something Told the Wild Geese" by Rachel Field?
- f) How does the poem contrast urban and natural environments in the poem "Green Escape" by Joseph Auslander?
- g) What does the poem suggest about the power of imagination in the poem "The News" by Michael Rosen?
- h) What message about life and existence might the poet be trying to convey in the poem "Contemplation"?

Part B - Writing (Marks: 30)**11. Read the opening of a story below and complete it in at least ten new sentences. Give a suitable title to it: 10**

One day, a hungry little boy was searching for food to eat. He looked for food here and there. Suddenly, he saw a pot. He took the pot and surprisingly found it filled with golden coins!

12. Write a paragraph on 'A Day to Remember' in 150 words: 10

13. Suppose you are Aiyan/Aiyana. You are having a chat with your cousin, Ratan/Ratna. Now, make a dialogue with him/her about the train/bus/aero plane journey that you have experienced recently: 10

Suggested Answers

1.
 - a) iii) folk music
 - b) iii) It is passed down through generations orally
 - c) iv) Lalon Giti
 - d) iii) Through oral tradition
 - e) iii) Bhatiyali
 - f) i) By keeping traditional stories, values, and customs alive
 - g) i) It is integrated into films and music albums
2.
 - a) Folk music reflects different aspects of life, such as agriculture, food, ecology, seasons, and rituals. These songs express the emotions, struggles, and celebrations of the common people, making them an essential part of their cultural identity.
 - b) Folk music instruments are made from naturally available materials such as animal skin, bamboo, and calabash. These materials are used because they are easily found in rural areas and produce sounds that reflect the natural environment and culture of the people.
 - c) As people migrate to cities and villages modernize, traditional folk music is gradually disappearing. Urbanization, technological advancements, and changing lifestyles have reduced the practice of oral transmission, leading to a decline in the preservation of folk traditions.

- d) Folk music in the hill tracts serves the same purpose as in other regions but is expressed in the diverse languages of ethnic communities. The instruments, rhythms, and themes of their music are shaped by their unique cultural backgrounds and natural surroundings.
 - e) Folk music keeps traditions, beliefs, and histories alive by passing them down through generations. It serves as a cultural archive, helping communities maintain their unique identity even in a rapidly changing world.
- 3.
- a) Admired
 - b) Providing
 - c) Progress
 - d) Enthusiasm
 - e) Conversations
- 4.
- a) Disrespect, Dishonor, Disregard
 - b) Remoteness, Separation, Gap, Space, Interval, Extent
 - c) Statement, Record, Announcement
 - d) Indifference, Disinterest, Disregard
 - e) Bud, Shoot, Grow, Flourish, Develop
- 5.
- a) Leo Tolstoy was a famous novelist, philosopher and moral critic of Russia.
 - b) He had a traumatic childhood as he lost his mother, father and his aunt who were their local guardian.
 - c) Childhood is his first novel which he wrote while serving the Army.
 - d) “War and Peace” followed by “Anna Karenina” and “The Death of Ivan Ilyich” are the trilogy which made him world famous.
 - e) He was buried in his own family estate in Tula province in Yasnaya Polyana where he lost most of his beloved ones.

6. a) False. C.A.: He was born in Yasnaya Polyana, Tula province, Russian Empire.
 b) True
 c) False. C.A.: He never completed his studies.
 d) True
 e) False. C.A.: He transferred only the copyrights of his works before 1881.

7. Leo Tolstoy, born on September 9, 1828, in Yasnaya Polyana, Russia, was a celebrated novelist, philosopher, and moral critic. Despite a difficult childhood, he became a literary icon with works like War and Peace, Anna Karenina, and The Death of Ivan Ilyich. After renouncing his wealth and transferring his copyrights to his wife, Tolstoy embarked on a pilgrimage incognito. He died on November 20, 1910, and was buried at his family estate in Yasnaya Polyana.

8. a) (a+iv) Garment workers generally work in factories and textile mills.
 b) (b+iii) Typically he or she works for 12 to 14 hours a day.
 c) (c+i) Low wages and long shifts are some of the major challenges that they face usually.
 d) (d+v) Due to lack of skills, they don't have any alternative job opportunities.
 e) (e+ii) But, for their livelihood and future, they demand job security and better pay.

9.

1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
e	g	c	a	h	d	b	f

10. a) The embroidered quilt symbolizes the woman's emotions, memories, and the story of Rupai's life, serving as a canvas for her grief and love.
 b) The central theme of the poem is the celebration of solitude and the peaceful, contented life that comes from living simply and without the distractions of society.
 c) The speaker pledges their love and toil for the years to come, expressing a commitment to their homeland and its future.

- d) The poem connects these themes by juxtaposing the little plant's awakening with the speaker's desire to express and share their grief.
- e) The wild geese begin their journey because they sense that the season is changing, and winter is approaching. The poem hints at an instinctual response to the shift in the environment, which signals them to migrate.
- f) The poem contrasts the chaos and artificiality of urban life with the tranquility and beauty of nature, emphasizing the speaker's preference for the latter.
- g) The poem suggests that imagination can bring ordinary objects, like shoes, to life, giving them personalities and stories that captivate the reader.
- h) The poet may be suggesting that while life is transient and full of uncertainties, moments of reflection and acceptance allow one to find peace and meaning in the present moment, even if answers to life's big questions remain elusive.

11. **The Boy and the Magic Pot**

One day, a hungry little boy was searching for food to eat. He looked for food here and there. Suddenly, he saw a pot. He took the pot and surprisingly found it filled with golden coins! At first, he thought it might be a mistake or a trick, but when he reached into the pot and felt the weight of the coins, he realized it was real. The boy could hardly believe his luck. He thought of all the food he could buy, the new clothes he could wear, and how he could finally live without worrying about where his next meal would come from.

But as he looked at the pot, he remembered something his mother had always told him: "True happiness isn't in wealth, but in helping others."

The boy paused, looking around at the empty street. He remembered all the other poor people in his village, who were also struggling to find food.

When he reached the village, he told the people about the pot of golden coins he had found. Instead of keeping the treasure for himself, he gave it away to the villagers, making sure everyone had enough to eat. The villagers were amazed and incredibly grateful for his kindness.

As the boy shared the last of the coins, something magical happened. The pot, which had been empty before, suddenly filled up again with more golden coins. The boy smiled, realizing that his generosity had brought him even more than he had expected.

From that day forward, the boy never went hungry again. The pot always had enough gold, not just for him, but for anyone who needed it. And the villagers, touched by his selflessness, treated each other with kindness and care, knowing that true wealth lay not in gold, but in the joy of helping one another.

12. A Day to Remember

One day I will always remember is the day I went on a family trip to the beach. It was a warm summer day, and the sky was clear with just a few clouds scattered across. We packed our bags early in the morning, filled with snacks, towels, and beach toys, and set off for the coast. As soon as we arrived, the sound of the waves crashing against the shore and the smell of the salty air instantly lifted my spirits. I spent the day building sandcastles with my younger sibling, swimming in the cool water, and laughing with my parents. We even had a picnic by the water, enjoying delicious sandwiches and fruit. As the sun began to set, the sky turned shades of pink and orange, creating a beautiful view. It was a day full of joy, love, and relaxation, and I'll always treasure those moments spent with my family.

13. Aiyana: Hello Ratan! What's up?
- Ratan: Just fantastic. Feeling good to see you again.
- Aiyana: Same here. It's really very interesting to travel together. You know something, I've always wanted to ride a train. Look how fast we are moving! The trees, fields, and houses are just flying past the window!
- Ratan: Yes. And look at how the train moves through the landscape—almost like it's a part of nature, flowing with the land. It's magical.
- Aiyana: You're right. I never thought of it that way. It feels like the train is telling its own story as it travels.
- Ratan: Yes, That would be incredible! Imagine all the places we could see— rivers, forests and hills.
- Aiyana: It's nice to feel like we're part of something bigger, like we're part of the journey itself.
- Ratan: Exactly
- Aiyana: I'm so happy.
- Ratan: Me too, Aiyana. I think this will be the first of many train journeys for us.
- Aiyana: Yes! Well, it's almost time to reach our stop. I'm so excited to see where we've arrived, but I'll always remember this journey.
- Ratan: Me too. It's not just about the destination; it's the experiences along the way that make it unforgettable.
- Aiyana: Let's move forward.
- Ratan: Okay. Let's go.

The End

2026 Academic Year

Class Eight : English For Today

Necessity is the mother of invention.

